

Series Title: Samaritan

Dates: October 5 - 26

Vision For The Event

Parables are not straight forward stories with one individual meaning. Instead, they have a depth to them that allows the hearer to experience the story in many ways. They can contain simple truths or complex realities, or both at once. This is why it is helpful sometimes to hear the same story and think about it from a variety of angles.

To begin the series, we will look at the nature of parables in general. Then, throughout the rest of the series, we will look at the Parable of the Good Samaritan from three different perspectives –The Levite, The Beaten Man, and The Lawyer.

The success of the series should be evaluated by how well it

- Helps the congregation experience the truths found within parables.
- Excites hearers to further engage with other parables in the Gospels.
- Communicates the distinct and holy nature of Jesus Christ.
- Success for this series will depend on our ability preach three distinct sermons about the same passage.

Sermon Schedule

Sunday	Sermon Title	Scripture
10/5/25	Parables	Matthew 13:10-17
10/12/25	The Parable of the Levite	Luke 10:25-37
10/19/25	The Parable of the Beaten Man	Luke 10:25-38
10/26/25	The Parable of the Lawyer	Luke 10:25-39

Synopses

Week 1 | Parables - Matthew 13:10-17

Jesus uses parables in part because of the Old Testament prophecy, which said that the Messiah would. But also because he is trying to communicate truths about a reality that is otherwise incomprehensible. The kingdom of God is so unlike anything else in the world that is only through comparisons and relatively ludicrous analogies that anything true about it can be said. So, instead of facts and figures, Jesus offers stories that, for many, just do not make sense.

Week 2 | The Parable of the Levite - Luke 10:25-37

Imagine you are the Levite, a priest of the Jewish faith, and you saw a man on the side of the road in need. There may be a piece of your humanity that beckons you to offer aid to this man. However, the rule of your religion prevents you from touching blood, and the way this man has been beaten most assuredly means you will be unclean after the encounter. Therefore, you are compelled to walk by on the other side. It is not until later that you hear of a non-Jewish man who did the very thing you were unwilling to do. Who provided aid when you would not and likely saved that man's life. Our question this week is, how many times in our actual lives are we very much like the Levite?

Week 3 | The Parable of the Beaten Man - Luke 10:25-37

There is a rare person who has not felt beaten up by life at some time or another. Life is hard. Sometimes, suffering happens because of something you did, and other times, it happens out of no fault of your own. This man did not bring his suffering on himself; he was the victim of a heinous and random act of violence. In desperate need of help, it seemed like the world was hell-bent on passing him by. Until someone completely unexpected showed up and provided for him the way no one else would, and in a way, he couldn't do for himself.

Week 4 | The Parable of the Lawyer - Luke 10:25-37

Though the lawyer is not in the parable itself, I feel like his story for us is like a parable unto itself. This is the story of a man who wanted to prove how bright he was and wanted to trip up the man who everyone else seemed unable to stump. He wanted to prove that he rightly understood things and that logic and a command of the law (or rules, or theology, or cultural standards) was the most important thing. It was only after an encounter with Christ that he was able to see the limitation of his logic. And through his story, we see how there is no greater way to gain knowledge of Christ than to have an experience with Christ.